

clear winners on either side. Detractors say that file sharing hurts sales and that you are breaking the law. Proponents of P2P argue that file sharing actually helps sales and the “fair use” provisions of copyright law makes it legal. Both trumpet numbers and research studies supporting their claims. And that’s just a surface scratch on the debates that rage!

As you can see, nobody is really clear on the way forward. At least not yet. However, current copyright law is clear enough. You cannot distribute copyrighted works without the permission of the copyright owner. At best, file sharing is in a quasi-legal state where you maybe punished if caught sharing copyrighted material without permission.

While we at *Digit* are a crazy bunch, we like to spin our loonies on the right side of law! Likewise, we would encourage the entire *Digit* community of readers to not break the law. Before sharing copyrighted work, check the terms of the copyright. Most artistic work (music, movies etc) and closed source software are usually not shareable via P2P. That said, there is still plenty of shareable material left over. Nearly all freeware, shareware and open source software is shareable. Works in the public domain or those whose copyrights have expired are also shareable. Music and movies released under a Creative Commons license are shareable. Pick out what you want, open your P2P client and go bleed your bandwidth with the good stuff!

### 13.1.3 P2P Clients

With the exception of BitTorrent, which we will tackle in the next section, sharing files with a P2P client is as simple as designating a folder as “shared” and dropping all the files you want to share into that folder. There are tens of hundreds (if not thousands!) of P2P clients out there. Choosing one which suits your requirements and personality is a matter of trial and error and you will need to try a few of them out before you find the one which fits. One word of caution, though: avoid those which come bundled with adware. Other than taking up available bandwidth and making simple